



The Sanding Block

An Eva Gallo Book

Eva Gallo

For every child who ever wanted to rush ahead. This story is for you.

The Sanding Block: A Woodworker's Lesson in Patience

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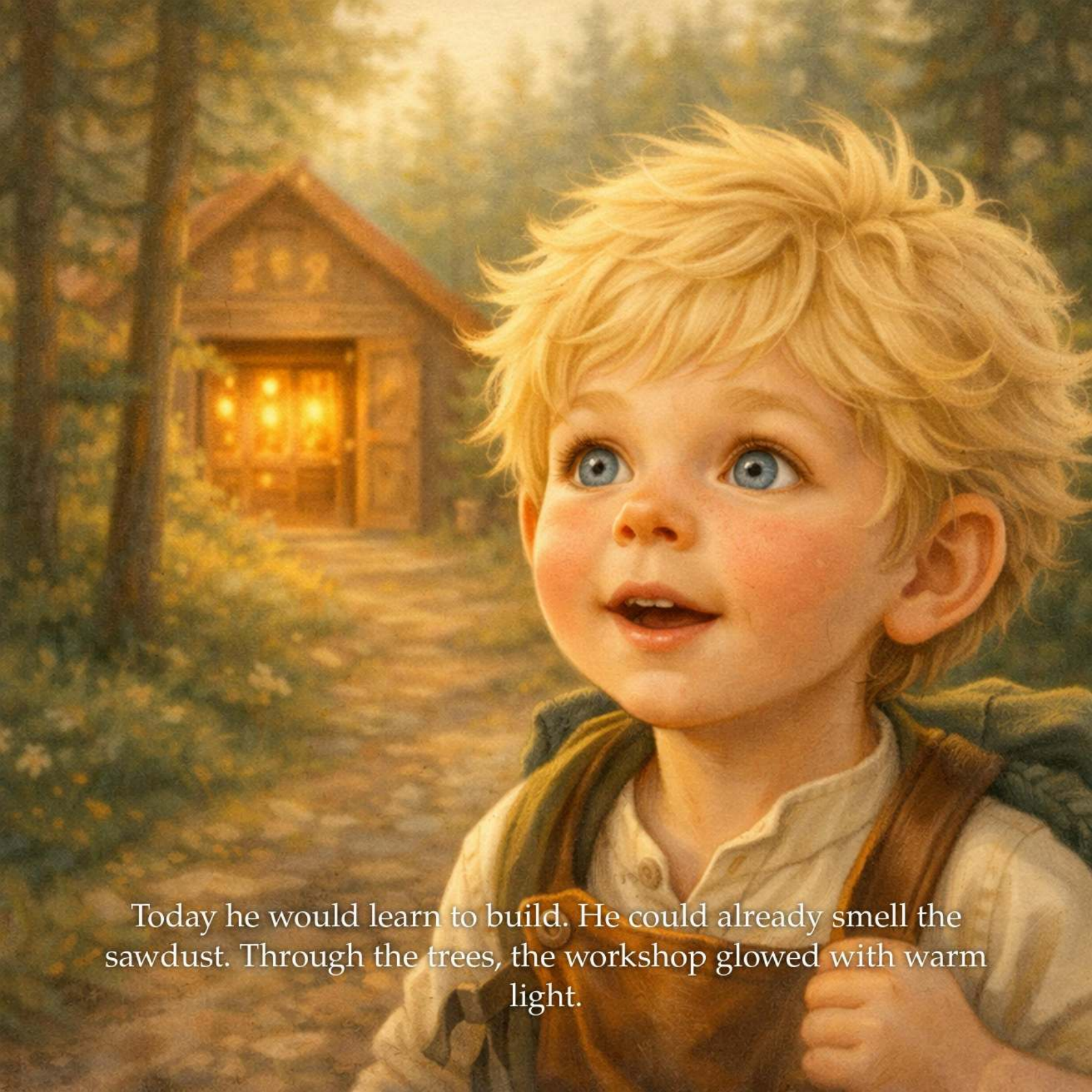
First Edition · For Ages 3 to 7

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Magnus had waited ALL summer for this day.



Today he would learn to build. He could already smell the sawdust. Through the trees, the workshop glowed with warm light.



He dreamed of dragons carved from oak. Of chairs that rocked
like boats. Of music boxes that sang.



He stepped through the workshop door. Master Anders looked up from his bench and smiled. The whole shop smelled of cedar and patience.



“Before you build,” said Master Anders, “you must learn to prepare.” He handed Magnus a broom.



Magnus looked at the broom. He looked at the tools on the wall, the chisels, the planes, the little mallet. He picked up the broom.



Magnus swept. Magnus stacked. Still no chisel. Still no saw.





Magnus organized every last nail. "When do I get to build?" he asked.



"Take this rough block of maple," said Master Anders. "Sand it until it feels like silk."



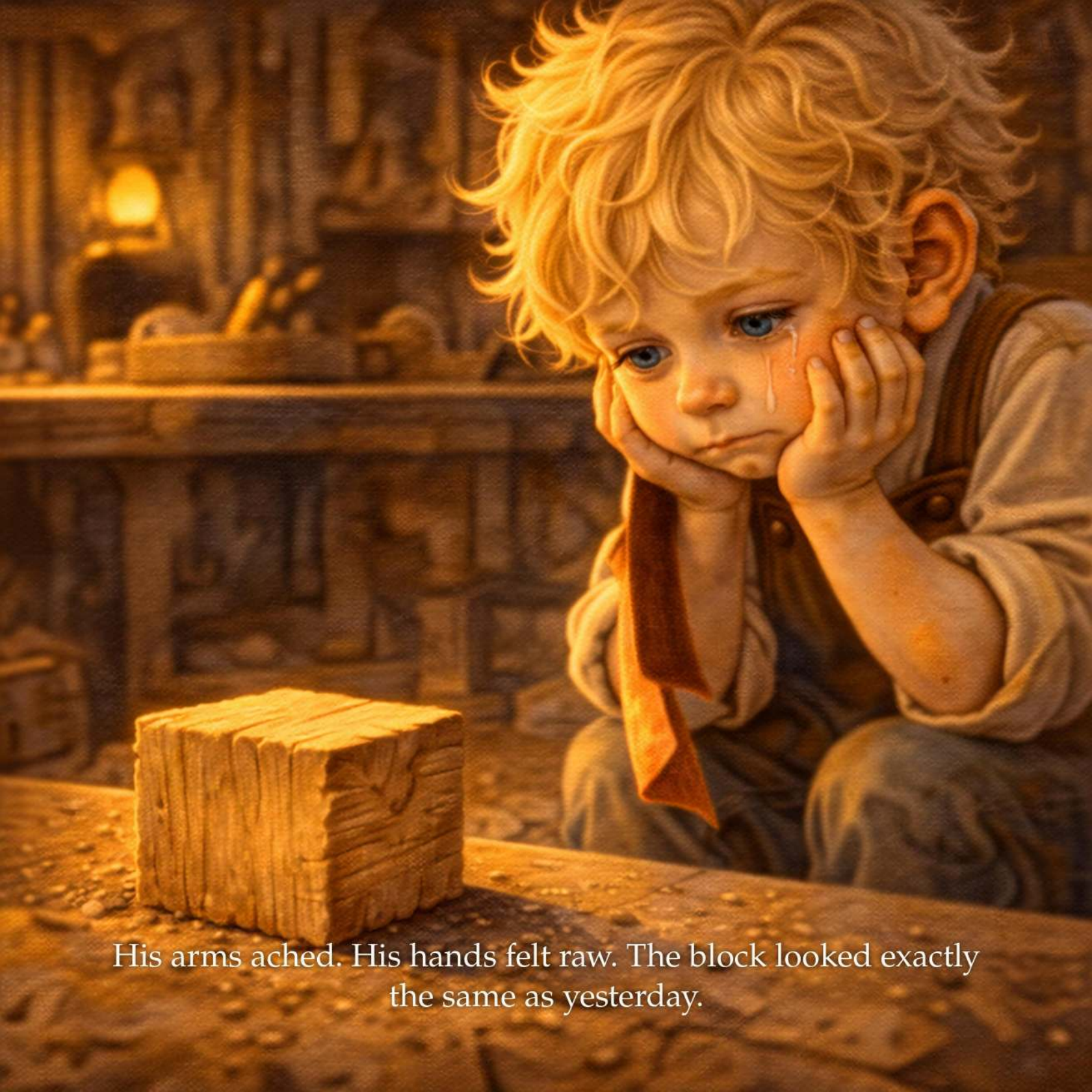
Magnus turned the block over in his hands. It felt like a rock.
The grain was rough against his palm. It felt like forever.



Magnus rubbed. And rubbed. And rubbed some more.



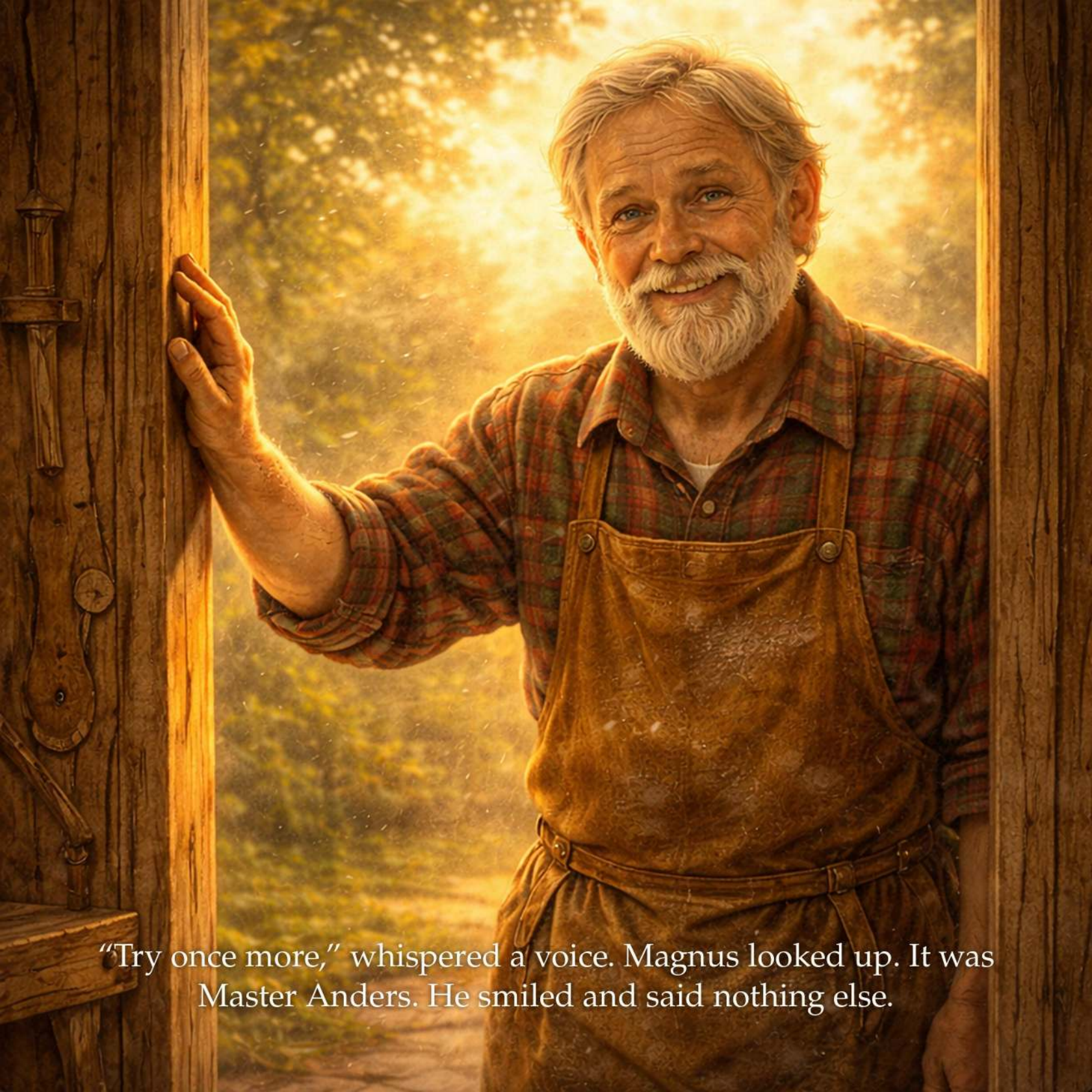
Morning. Midday. Afternoon. Evening. Magnus sanded through all of them. The block was still rough.



His arms ached. His hands felt raw. The block looked exactly
the same as yesterday.



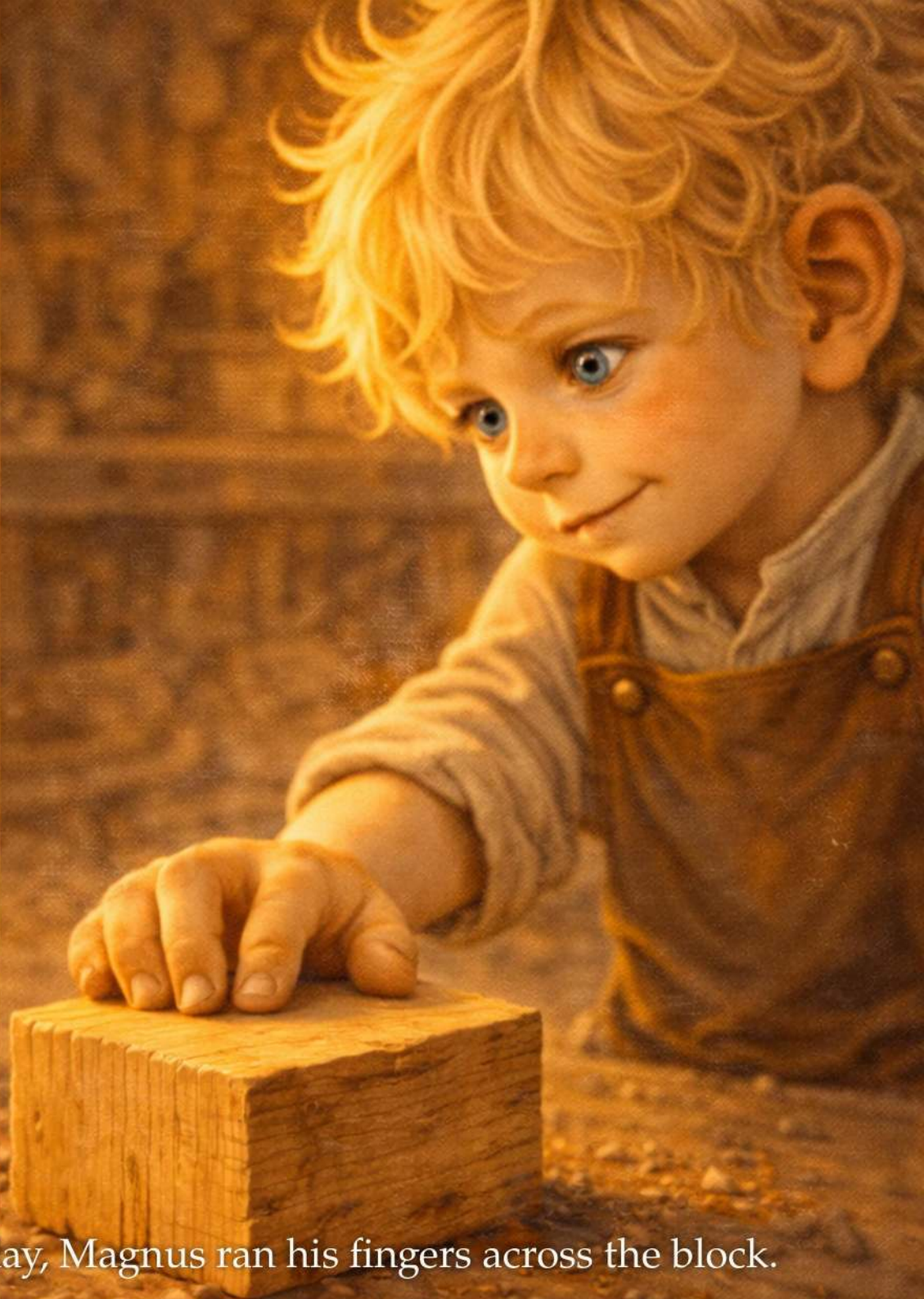
"Maybe," he thought, "I'm not meant to be a woodworker."



"Try once more," whispered a voice. Magnus looked up. It was Master Anders. He smiled and said nothing else.



Magnus looked at the block. He looked at the sandpaper. He picked it up.



On the seventh day, Magnus ran his fingers across the block.



Something was different. The grain had smoothed. The edges had softened. He ran his thumb across it slowly, once, twice, three times. Under his hand, the maple felt warm. It felt like, almost like,



"It feels like silk!" Magnus gasped.



Master Anders laughed, a warm, rumbling laugh. He clapped a hand on Magnus's shoulder. "Now you are ready," he said.



That afternoon, Magnus built his very first thing. He measured. He cut. He fitted the pieces together, and held his breath.





A small wooden bird. Small and imperfect and completely his.



Months passed. Then years. Magnus grew taller. His hands grew stronger.



And his work grew beautiful.



"How did you become so skilled?" people asked.



"My teacher taught me patience," Magnus said. He looked at the smooth block on the shelf behind him. "And a maple block."



Now Magnus has a shop of his own. And a new apprentice
stands at the door with curious eyes.



Magnus smiled. In his hand, a rough block of maple.



Patience is not waiting. Patience is doing the work, one rub at a time.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Eva Gallo

Eva Gallo writes picture books for children who notice things: the shadow on the wall, the bird on the windowsill, the small moments most people walk past.

Before she was an author, Eva spent thirty years in public health. When she retired, she became a full-time grandmother to two granddaughters with an appetite for stories. Every night she reaches back to her childhood, the memories with her mother and her aunt, the lessons passed down without anyone calling them lessons.

She has been thinking about kindness for a long time. About the specific bravery of choosing to help someone who hasn't been kind to you. About the fact that you never know what you are starting.

A portion of proceeds from every Eva Gallo book supports the SEN Yakaar Foundation, bringing books and learning resources to children. Learn more at senyakaar.org.

